

BHARAT

A Historical Journey

5,000 YEARS OF CIVILIZATION

# A Brief History *of Bharat*

From the world's earliest cities on the Indus to the world's largest democracy — a civilization that endured.

3300 BCE — Present

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3300 – 1300 BCE

# The Indus Valley *Civilization*

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The world's first urban civilization, spanning over 1 million sq. km across present-day India and Pakistan.

## PLANNED CITIES

Harappa and Mohenjo-daro featured grid-planned streets, advanced drainage systems, and multi-story homes — centuries ahead of their time.

## TRADE & CULTURE

Active maritime trade with Mesopotamia. A standardized system of weights, measures, and a still-undeciphered script.

## LEGACY

Over 1,000 settlements discovered. The civilization's decline around 1900 BCE remains one of history's great mysteries.



1500 – 500 BCE

# The Vedic & *Epic* Age

The age that gave the world the Vedas, Upanishads, Ramayana, and Mahabharata — the spiritual and philosophical foundations of Bharat.

4

VEDAS

108

UPANISHADS

18

PURANAS



322 BCE – 550 CE

# The *Golden Age* — Maurya & Gupta Empires

India's greatest ancient empires unified the subcontinent and produced unparalleled advances in science, mathematics, art, and governance.

## MAURYA EMPIRE

Chandragupta Maurya united most of the subcontinent. Emperor Ashoka embraced Buddhism after Kalinga's bloodshed and spread its message across Asia through the famous rock edicts.

## GUPTA EMPIRE

Aryabhata calculated pi and conceived zero. Kalidasa wrote immortal poetry. Universities like Nalanda attracted scholars from China and Central Asia. Surgery, astronomy, and metallurgy flourished.

## GLOBAL INFLUENCE

India held 32% of world GDP in 1 CE. Spice and silk trade routes linked Bharat to Rome, China, and Arabia. Indian numerals became the world's number system.



600 – 1526 CE

# Medieval *Kingdoms*

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A vibrant mosaic of Hindu and Islamic dynasties — each leaving an indelible mark on India's art, language, and architecture.

## CHOLA & VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRES

The Cholas built the world's greatest Hindu temples and commanded a naval empire across Southeast Asia. Vijayanagara preserved Dravidian culture at its zenith.

## THE DELHI SULTANATE

Five successive sultanates ruled northern India from 1206–1526, introducing Persian art, music, and architecture. The fusion gave birth to Urdu and Indo-Islamic architecture.

## BHAKTI & SUFI MOVEMENTS

Saints like Kabir, Mirabai, and Ramananda preached devotion beyond caste or creed, weaving a shared spiritual fabric across faiths.



1526 – 1857 CE

# The *Mughal Empire*

At its height, the Mughal Empire commanded 25% of world GDP and built monuments that define India's identity to this day. A synthesis of Persian, Timurid, and Indian cultures unlike any before.

*Akbar*

RELIGIOUS HARMONY

*Taj Mahal*

BUILT 1632 – 1653

25%

OF WORLD GDP



1757 – 1947 CE

# Colonial Rule & *Resistance*

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Two centuries of British rule reshaped India's economy, society, and polity — while igniting one of history's greatest independence movements.

## THE BRITISH EAST INDIA COMPANY

Beginning with the Battle of Plassey in 1757, the Company gradually seized control of the subcontinent, draining wealth through trade monopolies and taxation.

## THE 1857 UPRISING

India's first major war of independence united soldiers, peasants, and royalty against colonial rule — leading to direct British Crown governance.

## GANDHI & NON-COOPERATION

Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy of non-violent civil disobedience — Salt March, Quit India, Swadeshi — mobilized millions and forced Britain to the negotiating table.



1947 – PRESENT

# Modern *Bharat*

The world's largest democracy — 1.4 billion people, 22 official languages, a space program, and the globe's fastest-growing major economy. A civilization that endured 5,000 years is only accelerating.

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## 1.4B

POPULATION

## 5th

LARGEST ECONOMY

## Chandrayaan

MOON SOUTH POLE, 2023